27 August 1962. In addition, the southern Spanggur track had also been made into a regular highway. This allowed them to move medium artillery, RCL guns, heavy mortars and even tanks from their rear headquarters at Shingshang and Rudok.

On 26 June 1962, a section of 1/8 Gorkha had crossed the Pangong Tso and established Srijap West. Eight days later, Major Dhan Singh Thapa arrived with reinforcements and the picket became the headquarters of Charlie Company. By the middle of July, Srijap East, Srijap Jamini and Srijap Screen (an observation post) had been established. Simultaneously, on the southern shore of the Pangong Tso, Yula I was established. By the middle of July, to give depth to Yula I, Yulla II and a small observation post, Jamini Tilok had been established.

With the establishing of each post, the names would be stencilled onto the maps and little blue pins added in Command HQ and Army HQ to indicate the forward extent of the Indian positions. In reality, these were created as and remained mere defensive positions that at best could hold out for forty-eight hours. On 20 October, twenty-eight men were holding Srijap West under Dhan Singh Thapa; Srijap East had one platoon less a section; Srijap Jamini had three men; and Srijap Screen had a section consisting of ten men. On the southern side of the Pangong Tso, Yula I and Yula II were being held by a section of Gorkhas plus a section of engineers each; while Jamini Tilok had a section. A third post, Yula III was deployed as a listening post further to the south and was more contiguous with the Chushul Sector. This roughly meant that there were eighty Indian soldiers in the Srijap Sector and another fifty in the Yula Sector.

The Chinese objectives at this stage become quite clear, especially when looked at in conjunction with their moves in the Northern Sector. The Srijap Valley had to be secured and the Indo-Tibetan boundary pushed forward to meet their interpretation in line with Kongma. If Yula I and Yula II were also taken, then the extension of the boundary to the south would automatically place the entire Spanggur Tso in Chinese territory. For the time being, they decided not to broaden the frontage and did not engage Indian posts on the Rezang Range.

On 20 October, news of Chinese attacks all along the Northern Sector vindicated Daulet Singh’s stand that the Forward Policy would explode in India’s face if the Chinese decided to get aggressive. By then, reports from both Srijap and Yula sectors indicated that the Chinese were preparing to